Multiplayer Game: How to Host and Join

Step-by-step for the host (the person whose PC runs the game) and for each friend who joins. Windows PCs. Updated November 4, 2026.

> **Where to get the game (everyone):**
> https://github.com/juggernautjake/multiplayer-game/releases/latest
> Download **MultiplayerGame-windows.zip** from the "Assets" list on that page. The source code is at github.com/juggernautjake/multiplayer-game.

How joining works, in one minute

One person **hosts**: their PC runs the game and everyone else connects to it. When you host, the game shows **invite codes** such as `34CP1-P07KE`. An invite code is just the host's address packed into ten letters and digits. Friends paste it into the game and click **Join a friend**. Which code to send depends on where your friend is:

Where your friend is	What you both need	Code to send
In the same house, on the same Wi-Fi	Nothing extra	"same Wi-Fi"
Anywhere else (**recommended way**)	Both install **Tailscale** (free), and the host shares their PC with the friend (Part A, step 3)	"Tailscale"
Anywhere else (no Tailscale)	The host forwards UDP port 7777 on their router (Part A, step 3, option 2)	"over the internet"

Part A · Host steps (you)

1. Download and open the game

1. Open the latest release page and download **MultiplayerGame-windows.zip**.
2. Right-click the zip → **Extract All...** → Extract. Put the folder somewhere easy, like your Desktop.
3. Open the folder and double-click **MultiplayerGame.exe**.
4. If Windows shows "Windows protected your PC", click **More info** → **Run anyway**. This shows for any new app that isn't from a big publisher.

2. Allow it through the firewall (first time only)

1. The first time you click **Play / Host**, Windows Firewall asks whether MultiplayerGame may use the network.
2. Tick **both** boxes (Private and Public networks) and click **Allow**. Without this, friends can't reach you.

3. Missed it? Start menu → "Allow an app through Windows Firewall" → **Change settings** → find MultiplayerGame and tick Private and Public.

3. Set up a way for your friend to reach you (once)

Same Wi-Fi? Skip this step.

Option 1, Tailscale (recommended: no router settings). Tailscale puts your PCs on a private network over the internet.

1. Go to tailscale.com/download, install Tailscale for Windows, and sign in (Google, Microsoft or Apple account; it's free).
2. Open the admin page: login.tailscale.com/admin/machines.
3. Find your PC in the list, click the ⋯ menu at the end of its row → **Share...** → copy the share link.
4. Text or email that link to your friend. Once they accept it (Part B, step 2), they can reach your PC, and only your PC.
5. Keep Tailscale running (its icon sits by the clock) whenever you host.

Option 2, port forwarding (no Tailscale). Use this if your friend can't install Tailscale.

1. Find your PC's local address: it's the "same Wi-Fi" address the game shows when you host (for example `192.168.1.108`).
2. Open your router's settings page (often `192.168.1.1` or `192.168.0.1` in a browser, or your internet provider's app). The login is often on a sticker on the router.
3. Find **Port Forwarding** (sometimes under Advanced, NAT or Gaming). Add a rule: protocol **UDP**, port **7777** (both external and internal), to your PC's local address. Save.
4. Use the **"over the internet"** invite code. If your internet provider uses CGNAT (some phone and satellite internet does), port forwarding won't work; use Tailscale instead.

4. Host a game

1. Open MultiplayerGame.exe. Type your name in **Your name**.
2. Under **Look for everyone**, pick Pip (pixel sprite) or the 3D figure. You can switch everyone later with `F2`.
3. Leave the port at **7777**, then click **Play / Host**.
4. Your invite codes show at the top left of the screen, one per line:
   - **same Wi-Fi**: for people in your house;
   - **Tailscale**: for friends who accepted your share link;
   - **over the internet**: only if you set up port forwarding.

   The Tailscale code (or the Wi-Fi code if you have no Tailscale) is **already copied to your clipboard**.
5. Paste the code into a text or Discord message and send it to your friend.

6. Keep the game open: when you close it, the game ends for everyone. When a friend arrives you'll see "*name* joined".

> **Your codes stay the same** as long as your addresses don't change. The Tailscale code almost never changes, so a friend can reuse it next time.

Playing alone

Just click **Play / Host** and play. Nobody can join unless you send them a code.

Part B · Guest steps (send this page to your friend)

1. Download and open the game

1. Go to github.com/juggernautjake/multiplayer-game/releases/latest and download **MultiplayerGame-windows.zip** (under "Assets").
2. Right-click the zip → **Extract All...** → Extract.
3. Open the folder and double-click **MultiplayerGame.exe**. If Windows says "Windows protected your PC", click **More info** → **Run anyway**.

2. If the host sent you a Tailscale share link (once)

1. Install Tailscale from tailscale.com/download and sign in (free; any Google, Microsoft or Apple account).
2. Open the share link the host sent you and click **Accept**. The host's PC now shows in your Tailscale list.
3. Keep Tailscale running (its icon by the clock) whenever you play.

Same house or the host set up port forwarding? Skip this step.

3. Join the game

1. Make sure the host has the game open and hosting.
2. Open MultiplayerGame.exe and type your name in **Your name**.
3. Click the **Invite code or address** box, delete what's there, and paste the host's invite code (for example `34CP1-P07KE`). Capitals and the dash don't matter.
4. Click **Join a friend**. You'll be in the world within a few seconds.

If it says "No game answered"

- Check that the host's game is open and they clicked Play / Host.
- Check that you used the right kind of code: Tailscale code with Tailscale, Wi-Fi code only in the same house.
- Tailscale: both of you need it running, and you must have accepted the share link. In the Tailscale window you should see the host's PC.
- Host: make sure Windows Firewall allows MultiplayerGame on Private and Public networks (Part A, step 2).
- Port forwarding: the rule must be **UDP** 7777 to the host's current local address.

Controls (everyone)

Key	What it does
Mouse	Turn the camera around your character
W A S D	Move (relative to the camera)
Shift / Space / Q	Sprint / jump / dash
Left mouse	Attack. Click again for the next move of the combo. Hold to draw a bow or slingshot, let go to shoot. While you hold it, your character turns toward the crosshair
Right mouse	Aim: face where the camera looks and zoom in
E	Pick up the weapon you're standing on (ammo is picked up by walking over it)
1–5 or Tab	Fists, club, sword, bow, slingshot (the ones you have)
V / mouse wheel	First or third person / camera distance
F2	Host only: switch everyone between Pip and the 3D figure
Esc	Menu: resume, mouse sensitivity, leave